tests. Another way to do this is to make it seem like a concession to the other side, and secure benefits in another area to offset this 'concession'. This was the Chinese hope when they tried to persuade India to agree not to list any further terrorists based in Pakistan under the 1267 Sanctions Committee provisions in return for agreeing to the listing of Masood Azhar, although they recognized that the endgame had arrived. On that occasion, India was unwavering and the Chinese pragmatically decided to cut their losses.

After an agreement has been reached in the course of the negotiations across the table, the opposite side's interlocutor may feel that a result has been achieved, and tend to let down her or his guard. The Chinese, however, believe in the power of the written word, not of the spoken word. The drafting of language to capture on paper what has been orally agreed to, and in as precise and unambiguous a way as possible, is a critical part of the negotiating process with the Chinese. The Chinese are excellent drafters of text, and they have the capacity to draft the language in a manner that introduces ambiguity or allows for different interpretations. In general, a legal representative should be part of the Indian delegation when the drafting of agreements is involved. Every word must be parsed not only for its obvious meaning but for hidden interpretation. The *neti-neti* principle should be applied in reverse to eliminate any double meanings or alternative interpretations.

It is preferable to allow neither time pressure nor the fear of failure to cloud the judgement on the words in a draft agreement. Sometimes taking a leaf out of the Chinese playbook by suggesting that it is better to postpone the agreement for another occasion, is also a way of testing how desirable it is for China to conclude the agreement and hastening the process if this is the case. When the drafting of the text in the English